Module: Career, Resume & Interview Preparation — Placement Track

Phase: Placement & Career Readiness
Next step: Capstone completion, mock drives, job applications
Previous module: Testing Debugging Clean Code

Module Outcome:

- Tell a 60-second story of CampusCart that a recruiter can repeat
- Pin two repos with README, screenshot, and stack — not a dump of class files
- Walk a mock interview on your own code, not a memorised definition

Prerequisites

- Near-complete course projects on GitHub
- LinkedIn + professional email ready

Placement is a skill — not luck

After 16 weeks of Python full stack, **technical skill alone does not guarantee offer**. Indian hiring involves:

- Resume screening (HR + ATS)
- Aptitude/online tests (many service companies)
- Technical rounds (Python, Django, SQL, React basics)
- HR/manager (communication, salary, notice period)



Where used?
- Job hunt — Naukri / LinkedIn / company careers for junior Python roles
- Portfolio — GitHub pins + README for CampusCart / student CRUD
- Interviews — Agile vocabulary, STAR stories, SQL + Django basics
- Service / product teams — standup, sprint, PR review language on day one
- Switchers — frame prior domain + new stack projects honestly

This module turns you from "course completed" to **hire-ready candidate**.

Agile/Scrum in 5 minutes (interview vocabulary)

Most Indian product and service teams say they are **Agile**.

Term	Meaning
Sprint	1–2 week delivery cycle

Term	Meaning
Standup	Daily 15-min: yesterday, today, blockers
Backlog	List of tasks/features prioritized
Scrum Master	Facilitates process (not your boss necessarily)
Product Owner	Defines what to build
Retrospective	End of sprint: what went well/poorly

Interview line: "In training we simulated sprints with weekly demos and Git commits — similar to standup deliverables."

How to position your background

Recent graduate	Experience in another field
Emphasize projects, CGPA, internships	Emphasize transferable skills + why tech
Stack: Python, Django, React, MySQL	Prior domain + new stack bootcamp projects
Expect 3–6 LPA ranges (varies by city)	Honest about previous experience level

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Concepts

Resume structure (India Python roles)

1. **Header:** Name, phone, email, LinkedIn, GitHub, city
2. **Summary:** 2 lines — role target + stack + project highlight
3. **Skills:** Python, Django, DRF, React, MySQL, Git, REST, HTML/CSS (honest levels)
4. **Projects:** 2–3 with bullet impact (built X, used Y, result Z)
5. **Education:** Degree, year, college (reverse chronological)
6. **Certifications / Training:** KSR Python Full Stack — dates
7. **Optional:** Switcher — previous role 1–2 lines max

Avoid: Photo unless employer asks, full address, hobbies essay, lie about experience.

Remember: One-page PDF with GitHub links beats a three-page essay without demos.

Common Error: Listing “expert Django” with no repo → fails the first live coding / project walkthrough. Honest skills + working links win.

Interview: Use STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result) for “Tell me about a project” — e.g. CampusCart CRUD under a weekly sprint demo.

Note:
- 3-page resume → rejected by HR — keep one page PDF.
- No project links → "maybe fake" — put GitHub URLs on the resume.

- Generic summary → lost in the pile — target Python full stack.
- Lying skills → fails technical — honest list + learning.
- Switcher hides past → confusing story — brief positive framing.

Rewrite a weak "worked on Django" bullet into a strong outcome-focused line with concrete stack details.

```
# Weak
Worked on Django project

# Strong
Built Django Task Manager with login, owner-filtered CRUD, and MySQL — deployed checklist with DEBUG=Fa
```

Expected Output: (resume bullet you can paste)

```
Built Django Task Manager with login, owner-filtered CRUD, and MySQL — deployed checklist with
DEBUG=False
```

Write a one-line profile targeting Python full stack junior roles in Hyderabad, Bengaluru, or remote.

```
Python Full Stack learner (Django, MySQL, React) seeking junior developer roles in Hyderabad / Bengaluru
```

ATS keywords (sample)

Python, Django, Django REST Framework, React.js, MySQL, REST API, Git, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, OOP, SQL, Agile, Linux basics, Postman.

Use naturally in skills and project bullets — no keyword stuffing paragraph.

Build a keyword bank separated by middle dots for your Skills section on resume and LinkedIn.

```
Python · Django · MySQL · REST · DRF · Git · HTML · CSS · JavaScript · React · pytest · Linux
```

Note which JD keywords must appear in Skills and at least one project bullet when you tailor a Naukri application.

```
# JD asks: Django, REST API, MySQL
# My resume must show those exact words in Skills + one project bullet each
```

LinkedIn essentials

- **Headline:** "Aspiring Python Full Stack Developer | Django · React · MySQL | Open to opportunities"
- **About:** 3 short paragraphs — background, stack, projects with links
- **Featured:** GitHub repo links, demo video if any
- **Skills:** Endorsements from batchmates
- **Open to work:** Configure visibility (recruiter-only option exists)

Note:
- Only Naukri mass apply → low response — use LinkedIn + referrals too.

Rewrite a generic student headline into a Python full stack developer headline with location and open-to-work signal.

```
# Before
Student at XYZ College

# After
Python Full Stack Developer | Django · MySQL · React | Open to internships — Hyderabad
```

Plan three Featured section items — portfolio README, demo video, and certificate — for your LinkedIn profile.

```
1. GitHub portfolio README
2. CampusCart demo video (2 min)
3. Certificate / course completion PDF
```

GitHub portfolio checklist

- [ ] Profile README (`github.com/username/username` repo)
- [ ] 2–3 pinned repos with clear names: `django-task-api`, `react-product-ui`
- [ ] Each repo: README (setup, screenshots, tech stack)
- [ ] Commits show progression — not single upload
- [ ] No secrets, no `venv/` committed

List three pinned repos with clear names that showcase CLI, Django, and React work on your GitHub profile.

```
- expense-tracker (Python CLI)
- student-portal (Django + MySQL)
- product-browser (React + DRF)
```

Create a README checklist every pinned repo must have before you share the link with recruiters.

```
# Every pinned repo

- [ ] One-line description
- [ ] Setup steps
- [ ] Screenshot
- [ ] Tech stack
- [ ] Author + city
```

Mock interview plan (4-week)

Week	Focus	Activity
1	Intro + projects	5-min "tell me about yourself" recorded
2	Python + Django	20 technical Qs from course modules
3	SQL + React + API	Whiteboard CRUD flow
4	HR + salary + STAR	Full 45-min mock with peer

Note:
- Ignoring aptitude → fail OA — practise 30 minutes daily.

> Draft a four-week mock interview plan spanning Python, Django, REST/React, and STAR practice.

```
Week 1: Python + SQL basics (30 Q)
Week 2: Django MTV + auth (20 Q)
Week 3: REST + React fetch (15 Q)
Week 4: Full mock + STAR stories
```

Write a daily 20-minute drill covering yesterday's commit, one coding puzzle, and one STAR story out loud.

```
- 5 min: explain yesterday's commit
- 10 min: one coding puzzle (list/dict)
- 5 min: one STAR story out loud
```

STAR method (projects and prior work)

Situation — context

Task — your responsibility

Action — what you did

Result — measurable outcome

Example (BPO → Developer):
S: Handled 50+ customer tickets daily in telecom process.
T: Team wanted automated FAQ responses.
A: Learned Python, built Flask FAQ API prototype in training capstone.
R: Reduced lookup time in demo scenario; motivated completing the KSR full-stack course.

Write a STAR story for making tasks private per owner in the Task Manager project.

```
Situation: Tasks were visible to every user in class demo
Task: Make tasks private per owner
Action: Added User FK, @login_required, filtered QuerySet
Result: User A cannot see User B tasks; demo passed checklist
```

Write a STAR story for stopping a `.env` password leak using gitignore, password rotation, and `.env.example`.

```
Situation: .env with DB password almost pushed
Task: Stop secret leaks
Action: Added .gitignore, rotated password, wrote .env.example
Result: Repo clean; checklist green for deploy lab
```

Application tracker columns

| Company | Role | Date Applied | Source | Status | Next Follow-up | Notes |

Track: Applied → OA → Technical → HR → Offer/Rejected.

> **Note:**
> - No follow-up → missed opportunity — set a tracker reminder for 7 days.
>
> Create application tracker table headers and one sample row for a Naukri application.

```
| Date | Company | Role | Portal | Status | Next action | Notes |
|------|---------|------|--------|--------|-------------|-------|
```

```
| 03-Aug | Acme | Junior Python | Naukri | Applied | Follow up 10-Aug | Django JD |
```

Define your status vocabulary from Wishlist through Offer or Rejected for consistent tracker updates.

```
Wishlist → Applied → OA → Interview 1 → Interview 2 → Offer / Rejected / On hold
```

Step-by-Step Annotated Examples

Step 1 — Resume summary samples

entry-level:

> B.Tech graduate and KSR Python Full Stack trainee skilled in Django, DRF, React, and MySQL. Built full-stack product catalog with REST API and React UI. Seeking junior Python/Django developer role.

prior experience in another field:

> Professional transitioning from retail operations to software development with KSR Python Full Stack certification. Delivered Django + React capstone with authentication and API integration. Strong stakeholder communication from 4 years client-facing work.

Step 2 — Project bullet formula

Action verb + tech + outcome

- Developed **Django REST** Product API with serializers and Postman-tested CRUD endpoints.
- Built **React (Vite)** SPA consuming DRF backend with routing and form validation.
- Implemented **MySQL** schema with normalized tables and JOIN queries for reporting.

Step 3 — "Tell me about yourself" (90 seconds)

1. Who you are (education/background) — 20 sec
2. What you learned in course — 30 sec
3. Best project one-liner — 20 sec
4. What role you want — 20 sec

Practice until natural, not memorized robot tone.

Step 4 — GitHub profile README template

```
# Hi, I'm Priya Sharma

Aspiring **Python Full Stack Developer** from Hyderabad.

## Stack
Python · Django · DRF · React · MySQL · Git

## Projects
- [Product Catalog API](https://github.com/priya/product-api) — Django + DRF
- [React Product UI](https://github.com/priya/product-ui) — Vite + fetch

## Training
```

```
KSR Datavizon Python Full Stack (2026)

Open to junior developer roles — connect via LinkedIn.
```

Step 5 — Application tracker (sheet row example)

Company	Role	Date	Status	Notes
TechSoft Pune	Jr Python Dev	2026-08-01	Applied	Referral from alumni
CloudNine BLR	Django Intern	2026-08-02	OA scheduled	Revise SQL JOINs

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Practice Exercises

Basic

1. Draft resume v1 — peer review swap in pairs.
   Model answer:
   One page: contact, 3–5 bullet projects with tech + outcome, skills matching JD keywords, education. Peer checklist: quantify results, remove fluff, fix typos, ensure GitHub/LinkedIn links work.
2. Update LinkedIn headline and add 5 skills.
   Model answer:
   Headline example: `Python Full Stack Developer | Django · React · MySQL`. Add skills such as Python, Django, MySQL, JavaScript/React, Git — mirror your resume and pin them.
3. Write 90-sec intro script and read aloud 3 times.
   Model answer:
   Structure: who you are → training focus (Python full stack) → one project result → what role you want. Keep under 90 seconds; practice aloud until smooth, not memorized-robotic.

Intermediate

1. Two STAR stories documented (1 technical challenge, 1 teamwork).
   Model answer:
   Technical: Situation (CORS failing in React+DRF) → Task (ship demo) → Action (fixed headers, documented) → Result (demo worked). Teamwork: conflict on Git merge → coordinated branches/PR review → on-time delivery.
2. Pin 2 GitHub repos; add README screenshot each.
   Model answer:
   Pin capstone + one strong lab. Each README needs title, setup, screenshot of running UI, and tech stack. Profile → Customize pins → select the two repos.
3. Apply to 5 suitable roles with customized summary line.
   Model answer:
   For each JD, rewrite the resume summary to echo 2–3 required skills (e.g. Django REST, React). Track company, role, date, and summary line used in a simple spreadsheet.

Interview-style

1. Answer: "Difference between Django and Flask?" in 45 sec.
   Model answer:
   Django is batteries-included (ORM, admin, auth) for larger apps; Flask is a lightweight microframework where you add extensions as needed. I use Django for full portals and Flask for small APIs/prototypes.

2. Walk through your capstone architecture on whiteboard.
   Model answer:
   Sketch: React/Django templates (UI) → Django/DRF views → ORM/MySQL → auth/sessions. Mention env config, one key endpoint, and how you deploy (e.g. Render). Keep boxes and arrows, not code.
3. "Why should we hire you for this role?" — your answer.
   Model answer:
   Tie your projects to their stack, show you learn fast (cite a bug you fixed), and state you can contribute from week one on CRUD/APIs while growing into their domain. End with enthusiasm for their product, not generic praise.

Mini-Project (Assignment): Placement Kit

What to build

Deliverable folder `placement_kit/`:

- `resume.pdf` (final)
- `linkedin_checklist.md` (screenshots optional)
- `star_stories.md` (4 stories)
- `application_tracker.xlsx` or Google Sheet link
- `mock_interview_log.md` (date, feedback, improvements)

Stretch

- Record one 90-second intro video (name, stack, one project, city).
- Pin three GitHub repos that match resume bullets.

Done when

- [ ] Resume PDF uses strong bullets (not "worked on…")
- [ ] Four STAR stories written and practised aloud
- [ ] Tracker has at least 5 real or practice rows
- [ ] LinkedIn headline + GitHub pins match the resume story

Interview Q&A

Shared with students after concepts and the mini-project. Use for review and interview prep — questions and model answers are included.

1. Is one perfect project better than five half-done repos?
2. How to answer "expected CTC" as an entry-level candidate in Hyderabad vs Tier-2 city?
3. prior experience in another fields: how to handle "why leave previous field?"
4. What is imposter syndrome and normal response?
5. Referrals — how to ask politely without being pushy?

Q1. Tell me about yourself.
A: Structured 90-sec: background, training/stack, flagship project, role goal.

Q2. Walk me through your best project.
A: Problem, architecture (React + DRF + MySQL), your contributions, challenge solved, link.

Q3. What is Agile?

A: Iterative delivery in sprints with continuous feedback, standups, backlog prioritization.

Q4. Django ORM advantage?

A: Database operations in Python, migrations, less raw SQL for common CRUD — faster development.

Q5. Why Python full-stack development?

A: Honest motivation, structured training completed, portfolio proof, long-term commitment — tie past skills (communication/analytics) as assets.

Appendix: 30-Day Post-Course Plan

Weeks 1–2: Python/Django/DRF refresh + resume/LinkedIn. Weeks 3–4: SQL/React + mocks and applications. Daily: 30 min aptitude or one LeetCode Easy.

Appendix: Application Tracker Headers

`Company | Role | Applied Date | Status | Follow-up Date | Notes`